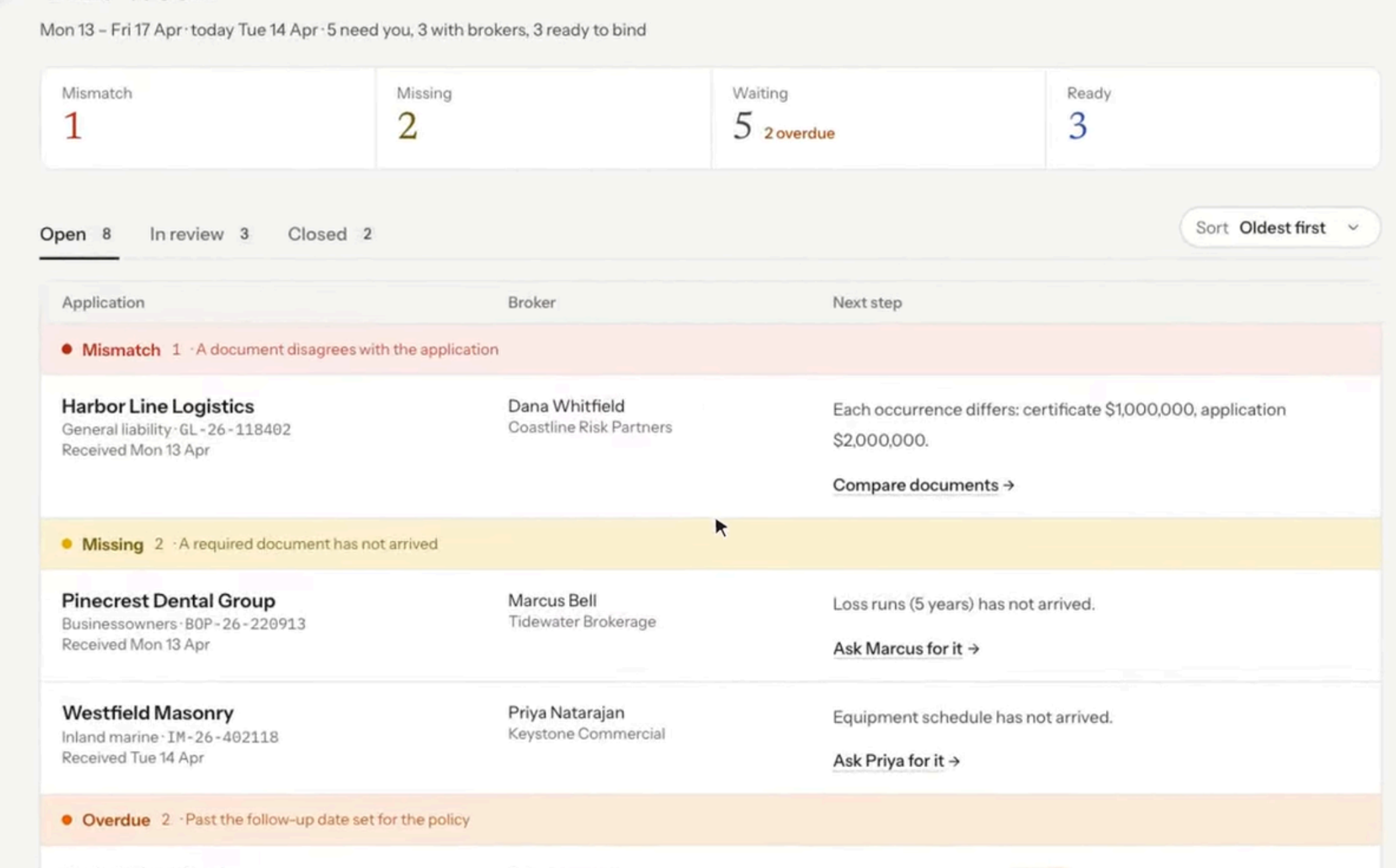

Mon 13 – Fri 17 Apr · today Tue 14 Apr · 5 need you, 3 with brokers, 3 ready to bind

Mismatch	Missing	Waiting	Ready
1	2	5 2 overdue	3

Application	Broker	Next step
● **Mismatch** 1 · A document disagrees with the application		
Harbor Line Logistics General liability · GL-26-118402 Received Mon 13 Apr	Dana Whitfield Coastline Risk Partners	Each occurrence differs: certificate $1,000,000, application $2,000,000. Compare documents →
● **Missing** 2 · A required document has not arrived		
Pinecrest Dental Group Businessowners · BOP-26-220913 Received Mon 13 Apr	Marcus Bell Tidewater Brokerage	Loss runs (5 years) has not arrived. Ask Marcus for it →
Westfield Masonry Inland marine · IM-26-402118 Received Tue 14 Apr	Priya Natarajan Keystone Commercial	Equipment schedule has not arrived. Ask Priya for it →
● **Overdue** 2 · Past the follow-up date set for the policy		
Kestrel Field Services	Priya Natarajan	No reply from Priya for 3 days on the signed payroll schedule.

BIND DESK PRODUCT DESIGN 2026

Redesigning the brokerage workflow so assistants decide instead of hunt

Self-initiated concept · Fictional company, people and data · Working prototype, not yet tested with users

Open the prototype Start the guided tour

TL;DR

The brief asks for a faster checklist. Its own logs show the checklist takes 3 minutes. So Bind Desk leaves it alone and redesigns the slow work around it, with a person approving every decision that matters.

THE BRIEF

"Make the checklist faster"

Bind Desk is set at a fictional 40-person insurance brokerage. Its assistants can't bind a policy until every document is in and every coverage limit matches. The operations director asks for a faster checklist, and the team's wishlist adds smart autofill, a cleaner interface, mobile access and an AI chat assistant.

The brief comes with 30 days of logs from the legacy checklist spreadsheet and notes from two assistant interviews, all fictional. I didn't run new research. I analyzed what the brief provided and mapped the journey, then defined the flow, designed the interface and built the prototype.

THE EVIDENCE

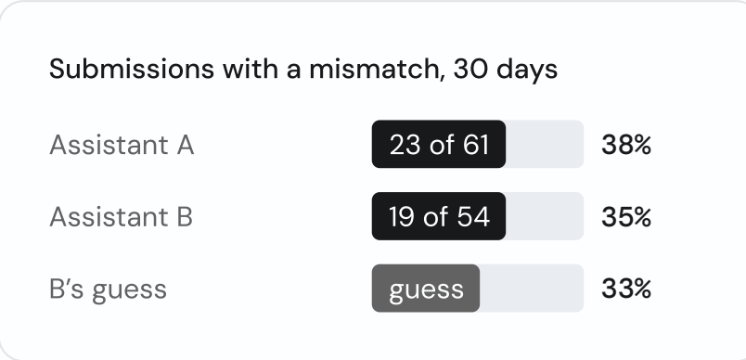
The checklist is the fastest step

Finding documents and reaching the first mismatch take longer, and broker replies take days.

WHERE THE SOURCES AGREE

Mismatches are frequent.

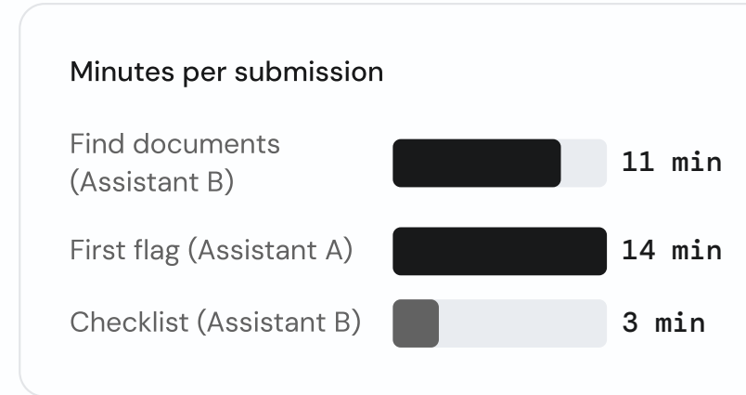
Assistant B guessed "maybe a third". The logs show 35–38%.


Submissions with a mismatch, 30 days

WHERE THEY DISAGREE

Assistant A wants autofill. Their log points elsewhere.

Their time goes to mismatches and broker waits.


Minutes per submission

Today's journey

	CAPTURE ○	TRIAGE ○	REVIEW ○	RESOLVE ○	FOLLOW UP ○	BIND ●
What happens	Documents arrive by portal, email or fax.	Open work, most urgent first.	Both documents side by side.	Broker email drafted from real mismatches.	A row turns Overdue after its follow-up date.	Checklist, summary, then approval.
Evidence	11 min to find them. 17 of 54 off-portal.	14 min before the first flag.	35–38% have a mismatch, found by reading.	"That can take days waiting on a reply."	Median 2.1 days. 9 waited over 4.	Checklist: 3 min. "I know it cold."
You	Confirm uncertain matches.	Choose what to open.	Mark each difference.	Edit and send.	Chase, call or wait.	Approve the bind.

○ A gap, not on the wishlist ● Agrees: leave the checklist alone

THE REFRAME

Leave the checklist alone

Speeding up a 3-minute step would save little. The time goes to the steps around it, so I kept the checklist as it is and gave every wishlist item a place sized to its evidence.

Every wishlist item, sized to its evidence

Asked for	How it appears	Evidence
Smart autofill	Suggested values in missing-document gaps only	Weak: one passing mention
Cleaner interface	The design itself	No user evidence
Mobile access	One status list for chasing brokers	No evidence of need
AI chat assistant	Held back	Nobody described a question for it
"Don't touch the checklist"	Unchanged	Supported: 3 min

PUSHBACK IN THE BRIEF

"Our users asked for the wishlist. Why are you showing me something else?"

My answer: the checklist is 3 minutes of the work. Nothing on the wishlist is dropped without a reason in the table above.

HUMAN CHECKPOINTS

The tool proposes, a person decides

Every AI output in the prototype carries a tag: what it did, whether a person has reviewed it, and why. Nothing irreversible happens on its own: no email leaves and no policy binds without a person.

Document intelligence
Compared 9 fields across 2 documents
Needs your review Why?

Agent
Drafted the broker email from your decisions
Confirmed by you Why?

Integration
Reads attachments in the open web inbox
Automatic Why?

Private environment
Assumes documents stay inside the firm's own environment
Automatic Why?

THE DESIGN

Seven moments, in the order the work happens

Each follows a stage of the journey above. The videos are recorded from the prototype.

CAPTURE

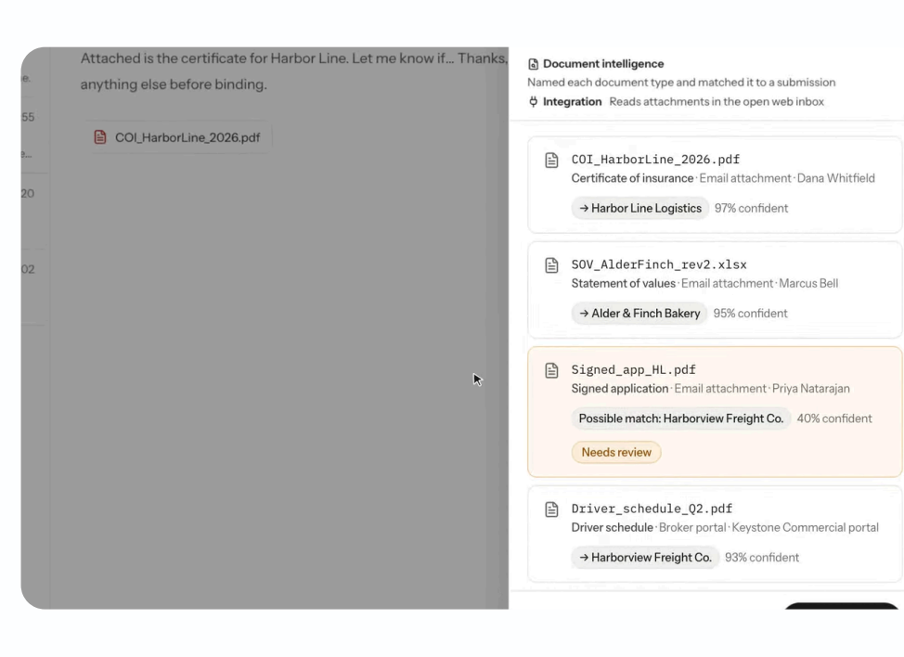
Pick documents up where they already arrive

A capture panel reads the inbox and portal notices, and only reads. It matches each document to its application, and when a match is unsure it says so and asks.

About a third of submissions arrive off the portal, and finding documents is the longest step before review.

> Human checkpoint: You confirm any match under 80%.

Assumes the panel can read the inbox or portal. If not, drag-and-drop or a scan folder.



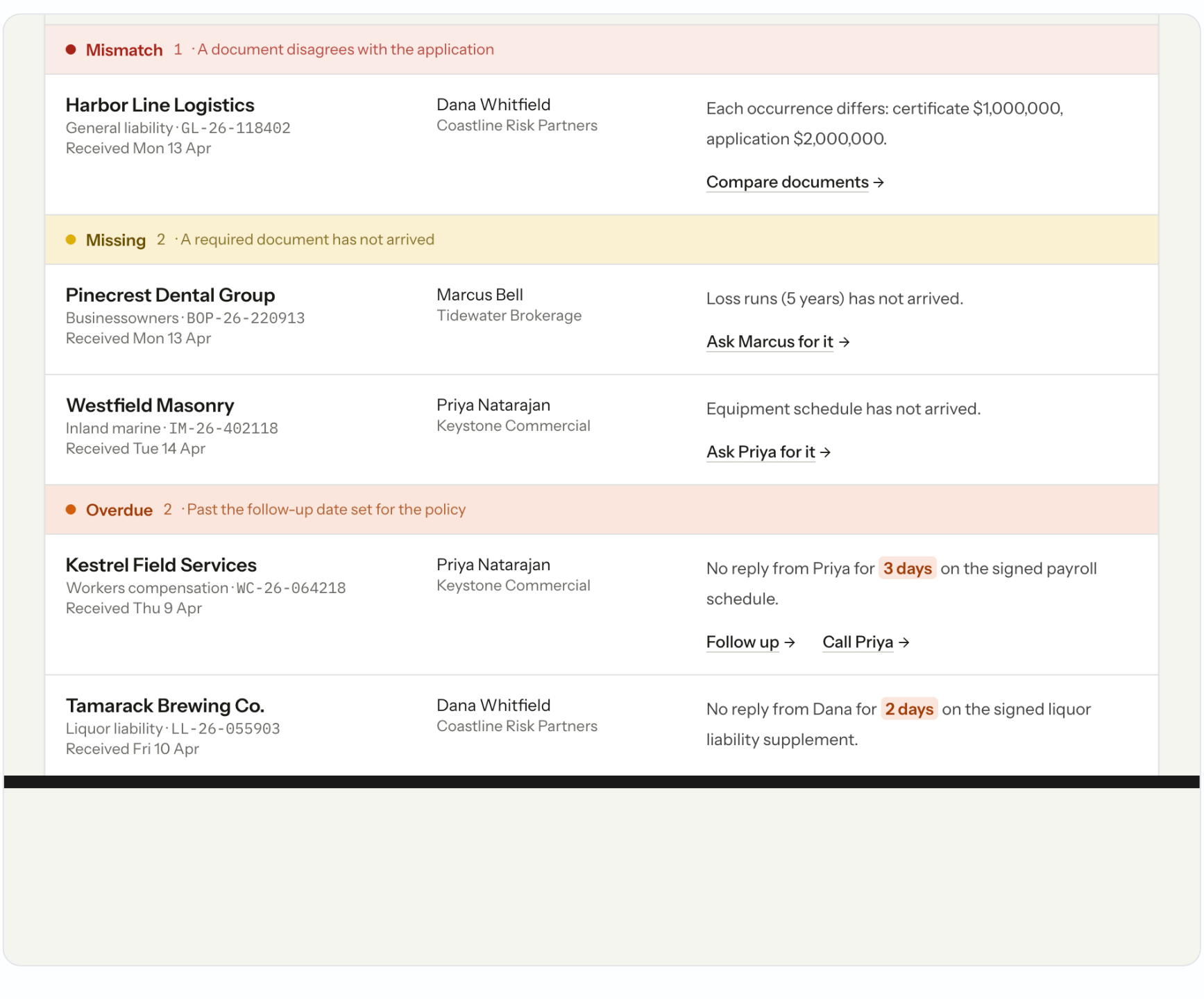
TRIAGE

Group the week by what blocks binding

Home groups work as Mismatch, Missing, Overdue and Waiting, and each row says what to do next, so it reads as a to-do list, not a report.

Assistant A reached their first flag 14 minutes in. Blocking work now sits at the top.

> Human checkpoint: You choose what to open.



● **Mismatch** 1 · A document disagrees with the application		
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Westfield Masonry Inland marine · IM-26-402118 Received Tue 14 Apr	Priya Natarajan Keystone Commercial	Equipment schedule has not arrived. Ask Priya for it →
● **Overdue** 2 · Past the follow-up date set for the policy		
Kestrel Field Services Workers compensation · WC-26-064218 Received Thu 9 Apr	Priya Natarajan Keystone Commercial	No reply from Priya for 3 days on the signed payroll schedule. Follow up → Call Priya →
Tamarack Brewing Co. Liquor liability · LL-26-055903 Received Fri 10 Apr	Dana Whitfield Coastline Risk Partners	No reply from Dana for 2 days on the signed liquor liability supplement.

REVIEW

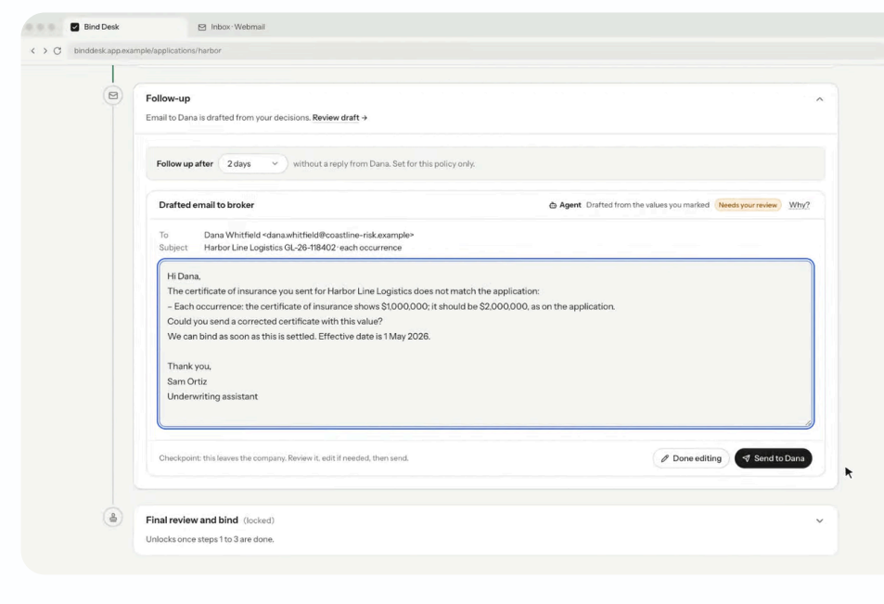
The tool highlights, a person decides

Both documents sit side by side with differences highlighted. The tool never decides: a person marks every difference real or acceptable.

More than a third of submissions have a mismatch, and today they're found by careful reading.

> Human checkpoint: You mark each difference.

Assumes every flag needs a person. If not, minor differences are auto-classified.



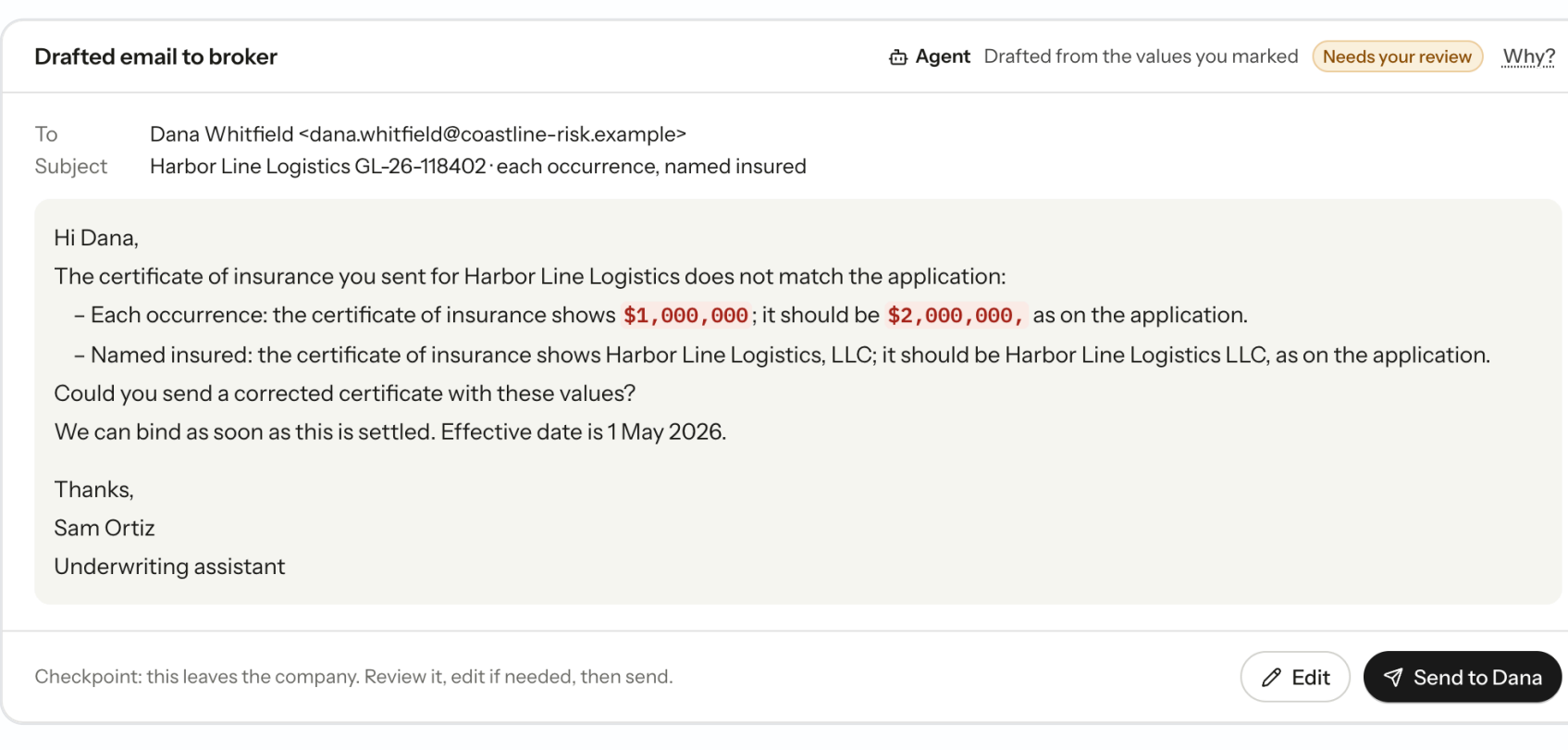
RESOLVE

Draft the email from your decisions

The draft cites the exact values you marked, and nothing leaves the company until you press Send.

A broker reply takes days, so the first email has to ask the right question.

> Human checkpoint: You edit and send.


Drafted email to broker Agent Drafted from the values you marked Needs your review Why?

To Dana Whitfield <dana.whitfield@coastline-risk.example>
Subject Harbor Line Logistics GL-26-118402 · each occurrence, named insured

Hi Dana,
The certificate of insurance you sent for Harbor Line Logistics does not match the application:
– Each occurrence: the certificate of insurance shows $1,000,000; it should be $2,000,000, as on the application.
– Named insured: the certificate of insurance shows Harbor Line Logistics, LLC; it should be Harbor Line Logistics LLC, as on the application.
Could you send a corrected certificate with these values?
We can bind as soon as this is settled. Effective date is 1 May 2026.

Thanks,
Sam Ortiz
Underwriting assistant

Checkpoint: this leaves the company. Review it, edit if needed, then send. Edit Send to Dana

FOLLOW UP

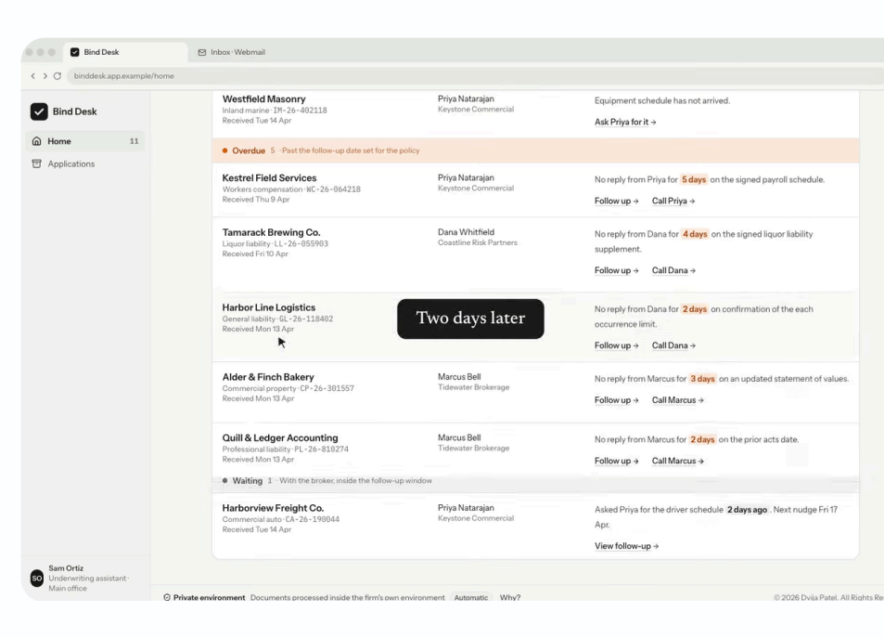
Make waiting visible

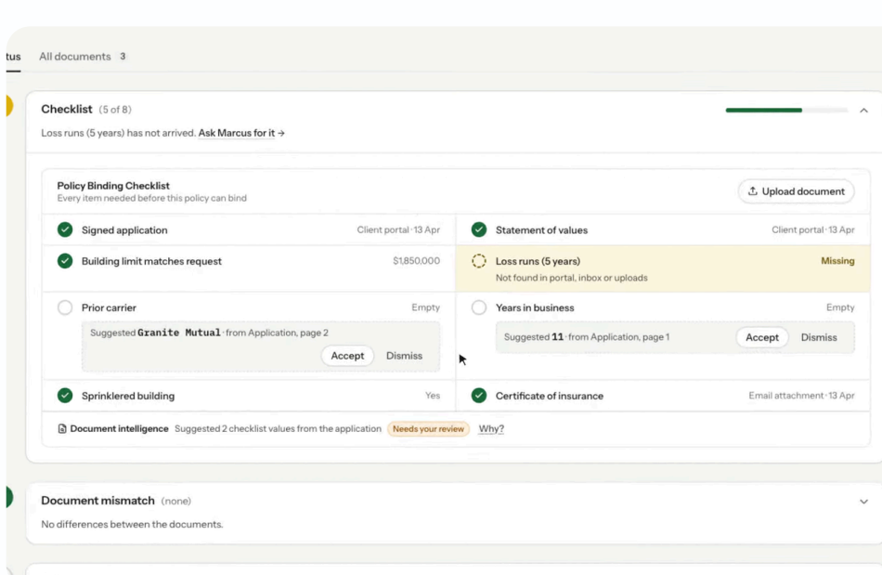
Each application carries its own follow-up date. When it passes, the row turns Overdue on Home.

The median reply is 2.1 days, and 9 submissions waited more than four with nobody tracking them.

> Human checkpoint: You chase, call or wait.

Assumes a date per policy is enough. If some brokers are always slow, the default is set per broker.





BIND

Autofill, kept to the gaps

When a document is missing, the gap shows in place on the checklist with suggested values.

Autofill had one passing mention in the interviews, so it gets the smallest role: suggestions in the gaps, and the checklist itself unchanged.

> Human checkpoint: You accept or dismiss each suggestion.

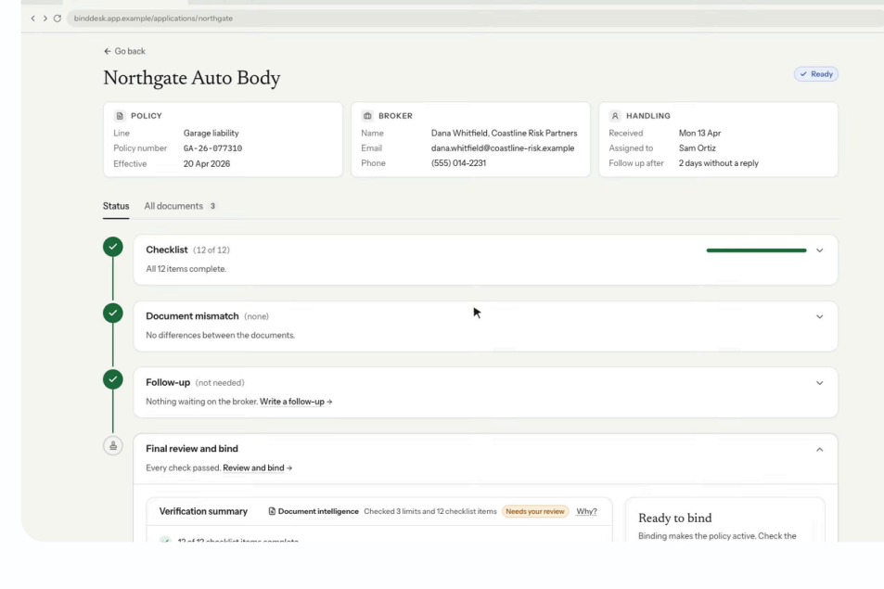
BIND

Show what was verified before an irreversible bind

A summary of every check comes before an explicit approval.

Binding can't be undone, and a missed mismatch "comes back to bite us later."

> Human checkpoint: You approve the bind.



Try the prototype ↗

EVALUATION

How I'd know it works

Bind Desk hasn't been tested with assistants. These are the measures I'd compare against the brief's logs, and the results that would tell me the design is wrong.

Area	Today	Measure	Would count against it
Finding documents	11 min per submission. 17 of 54 off-portal.	Time from arrival to a confirmed match	Assistants search by hand anyway, or reject many matches
Spotting mismatches	14 min to the first flag. 35–38% have one.	Time to first flag, and mismatches caught in a seeded set	Assistants miss mismatches the tool highlighted, or override it often
Chasing brokers	Median reply 2.1 days. 9 waited over 4.	Submissions waiting more than 4 days	Overdue rows sit untouched
Binding	Checklist: 3 min.	Checklist time stays flat	The checklist gets slower

Build the mismatch check first

Start where the evidence is strongest. The next round decides the rest.

Step 1
Build the mismatch check first
It covers the most frequent problem in the logs.

Step 2
Test it on a seeded week
Two or three assistants work the same submissions in the prototype and in the spreadsheet. Compare time to first flag and mismatches caught.

Step 3
Let the answers set the scope
The questions below decide how capture and follow-ups work.

What I still need to learn

Each answer confirms the design or changes one part of it.

Q1
How do documents reach you?

Assumed	Portal, email and fax
If wrong	Build the main channel first, or add a broker upload link

Shapes: Pick documents up where they arrive

Q2
Can faxes go to an inbox?

Assumed	Yes
If wrong	Scan upload becomes a core feature

Shapes: Pick documents up where they arrive

Q3
When and how do you chase brokers?

Assumed	A follow-up date per policy, repeat emails
If wrong	Per-broker defaults and free-form drafts

Shapes: Make waiting visible

Q4
Is there a rule for minor mismatches?

Assumed	No, so a person checks every flag
If wrong	Auto-classify minor differences

Shapes: The tool highlights, a person decides

HOW I USED AI

How I used AI

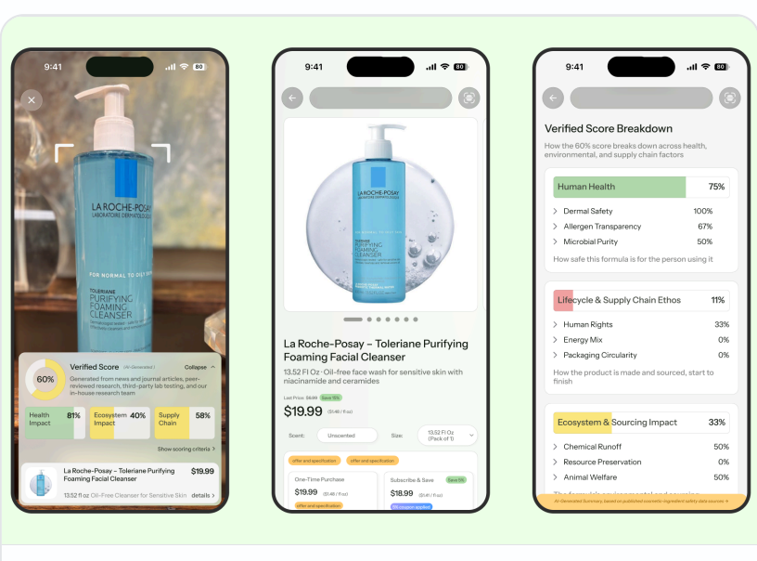
I made the design decisions. AI helped me carry them out.

Area 1
Analysis
I analyzed the logs, read the interviews for needs and mapped the journey. AI helped sort the evidence.

Area 2
Product and design
I defined the flow, where each human checkpoint sits, the layout and the brand, and tried several directions.

Area 3
Build
I built the prototype, with AI writing much of the code to the flow, states and checkpoints I set.

ALSO CHECKOUT



GREENERA UI/UX DESIGN 2025

A Product Page That Tells You Which Sustainability Claims To Trust

BILLY & BUDDY
Basket of choices

BILLY & BUDDY SERVICE DESIGN

A Mini Game That Teaches Kids To Tell A Need From A Want, In Two Minutes

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Company, people and data in this case study are fictional.

Intro
TL;DR
The Brief
The Evidence
The Reframe
Human Checkpoints
The Design
Evaluation
How I Used AI